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Conformity is an Expression of Insecurity

The laws and rules that have been created for society are one of the distinctions that separate humans from their primordial ancestors. It is through the inconsistencies of these laws where conformity has to be introduced. Members of a society will constantly try to get ahead of one another by utilizing loopholes found in the law, thus causing leaders to create strict consequences for those who choose not to follow these specific laws. This is how conformity begins in a society. The introduction of conformity brings with it the evident insecurities amongst those who introduce the conforming, as well as those who advocate it. But it is not only the leaders who exhibit their insecurities. Conformity expresses the insecurities in all affected parties, as it masks leaders' fears, displays people's unwillingness to resist conforming, and proves the motives in which anarchists act upon.

A community's strength is parallel to its leader's apparent strength, so anything that can be used to make a leader appear weak is frequently pointed out by their opposition, and on occasion, their followers. The leaders' insecurities, then, are hidden behind the act of conformity. An example of this throughout history can be seen through the People's Republic of China, which is currently the acting government for China. This government has enforced a system in select parts of the country called the “Social Credit System” and acts as an autonomous method to enforce wide scale conformity upon all in the system. The system functions by starting all citizens with a base credit of one thousand (Donnelly), and adding or removing points based upon their actions,

which are constantly monitored by cameras. A user's credit changes their standing in society. The higher a person's score, the more opportunities they will have access to in life, and vice versa.

The acts which lead to the highest point removal are often those most frowned upon by the government, and acts which grant the most points are most appreciated. This system is a glaring reflection of the leaders' angst and insecurities. They force their people to conform to a set of standards which they deem to be acceptable and, if the people choose to transgress, they are treated as mere outcasts in their society. Therefore, victims of such treatment have no choice but to adhere to conformity so that their lives do not become nullified, and the insecurities of the leaders' can remain unearthed.

In a functioning society, it's known that there are different hierarchical levels. At the top resides the leaders, the introducers of conformity. Below that level exists the working class. This social standing contains the majority of the population, and can be defined as anyone who works a career strictly to provide their labor or knowledge, and expects nothing but a salary in return.

These workers "have little control over the pace or the content of their work"(Gray, Kish-Gephart). From a young age, individuals are conditioned to obey those of a higher authority, whether it be their parents, teachers, or anyone else deemed to have prestige. This foundational knowledge is abused later in life by those same people. The working class of society cannot mask their insecurities by making others conform, but their insecurities can be reflected through an unwillingness to rebel and stand up for what they believe in. A person who conforms to their government's strict laws (in fear of the outcome) can be deemed as reasonable, as far as working class conformists go. This obedience is purely out of fear, knowing that if they step out of line, the consequences could be fatal. An individual who conforms to a single person acts purely out of insecurity, and not of fear. These are the people who allow conformity to

function. The insecurities of the working class are not as broad as their leaders, but rather they reflect a conditioned insecurity which is shared amongst their class.

Both parties whose insecurities are displayed strictly through conformity have been named: The leaders, and the working class conformists. There remains one more group, deemed to be below the working class in a functioning society. This group of people are known as anarchists. To be an anarchist is to rebel against conformity and any repressing laws and, as defined by Theodore John Kaczynski, "The anarchist too seeks power, but he seeks it on an individual or small-group basis; he wants individuals and small groups to be able to control the circumstances of their own lives"(Kaczynski). The aforementioned groups have insecurities towards their own fears.

Anything they can do to repress these fears will be done, hence why conformity is enforced on the majority of the population. In contrast to these groups, anarchists' insecurities are found to be antithetical to the conformist. If there is a law or order in place that an anarchist feels is a violation of their basic rights, then rebellion ensues. Someone who is classified as an anarchist would view the conformist as being an insecure member of society. This belief is false, as anarchists have their insecurities exhibited by conformity as well. The main insecurity of an anarchist is fitting in with the masses. If forced to conform, whether it be by wearing specific clothing, worshipping a single deity, or following explicit orders, the anarchist will attempt to revolt against any conformity. Their insecurity is near palpable at this point, as if the anarchist does not rebel, they will feel shameful, guilty, and insecure that their actions are not of their choosing.

Insecurities exist in everyone. What contrasts people's insecurities from one another are their methods of exhibition. The leaders are insecure about disorder in their society, so they make rules that people must conform to. The conformist is insecure about the retaliation that would

follow with stepping out of line, so they willingly oblige to the conforming. The anarchist is insecure about blending into the crowd and not living their own life, so they make it their life's mission to rebel against any conformity that is seemingly unethical or unjust. Conformity will always exist, and regardless of the position that a person plays in its process, conformity will always act as a glaring expression of a person's insecurity.

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